

AstraZeneca

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Approvals

Approval Reason

Owner Approval

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Date

2018/04/13 17:23:44



GLOBAL STANDARD Publications

KEY PRINCIPLES

- **We make a good faith effort to publish our results in peer-reviewed journals in a timely way to demonstrate transparency.**
- **We strive to publish our study results even if they are unfavourable to us.**
- **We follow Good Publications Practice guidelines and ICMJE Recommendations in sharing objective, meaningful scientific information about our studies without compromising our intellectual property.**

WHY IT MATTERS

Science is at the core of everything we do, and our company reputation is often judged by the integrity of our publications. Publications are important to the practice of medicine in supporting diagnosis, treatment and health care policy decisions. Because published information from our research can change standards of care, it is important that we gather and publish our clinical study data and related information in an unbiased, objective, transparent, and ethical manner.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- We publish clinical study and other medically important research results, whether positive, negative or inconclusive, while protecting patient confidentiality.
- We provide authors with access to relevant study data.
- Our publications acknowledge non-author contributors, including professional writers.
- Our publications disclose authorship affiliations and any personal or financial relationship that could be seen as having the potential to bias an author's work.
- Our publications acknowledge all financial support for publications and funding sources for the research being reported.
- We do not financially compensate authors for publication authorship.
- We document all other payments, reimbursements, and transfers of value relevant to the publication in accordance with regulatory requirements.
- We ensure that AstraZeneca-sponsored publications undergo appropriate review without influencing the opinions of authors, ensuring medical and scientific accuracy and protection of our intellectual property.
- We avoid publication redundancy by ensuring there is a specific educational, scientific, or medical need for each publication.
- We issue author agreements that clearly articulate authorship rights and obligations to abide by the principles of good publication practice.
- We ensure that our publications are truthful, accurate and not misleading, and they are never intended for purposes of off-label or pre-approval promotion.

PUBLICATION OF RESULTS FROM HUMAN STUDIES

- We make good-faith efforts to publish the results from all studies conducted in humans or involving human data in a timely manner, regardless of whether the study outcome was positive or negative.
 - At a minimum, clinical study results from phase 3 and onward, in addition to any research results of significant medical importance will be submitted to a peer-reviewed journal. This includes investigational clinical products from discontinued programmes and post-hoc analyses of medical importance.

- We make every effort to publish negative or neutral studies as a citable journal article and not just as a congress abstract submission or clinical trial website entry.
- We make good-faith effort to submit the primary manuscript within 18 months (6 months for paediatric studies) of study completion which is defined as last subject last visit.
- We give authors, upon request, access to copies of documentation related to the research, such as the study report, final protocol, statistical tables, and figures, as well as individual-level study data under conditions that protect patient confidentiality and intellectual property.
- We provide a redacted copy of the study report and protocol (including the statistical analysis plan and with intellectual property and personally identifiable information redacted), when requested by a journal considering a submitted manuscript for publication.
- We post redacted protocols for all clinical studies of investigational and approved products in accordance with the requirements and timelines specified in the AstraZeneca Clinical Trials Transparency Global Standard.
- We include the unique trial identifier in all publications and website postings of clinical studies.

PUBLICATION OF RESULTS FROM NONHUMAN STUDIES

- We commit to publish all results from nonhuman studies where patient safety is a consideration.
- In the interest of transparency, we will attempt to publish scientifically meaningful results for the benefit of the wider scientific community.
- We comply with external guidelines and best practices and undergo legal review and sign-off to ensure protection of our intellectual property rights and patents.

PUBLICATION PLANNING

- We develop publication plans to meet specific educational, scientific or data dissemination objectives. Publication plans are not developed with the intent to promote use of a product for which regulatory approval will not be sought or to unduly influence prescribers.
- We review publication plans annually in accordance with appropriate functional or local governance processes. All marketing companies are highly encouraged to submit product or therapy area publication proposals for review & approval prior to starting work on the publication, thus reducing chance of rejection due to misalignment to global medical objectives.
- We strive to only work with HCPs who remain in good standing in their medical practices. We further ensure that US healthcare professionals have not been debarred or suspended from participating in US Federal health programs before inviting them to participate in a publication, as these individuals must not be engaged as authors for AZ supported publications.

AUTHOR AGREEMENTS

- We issue author agreements to external authors prior to initiating work on publications (if publication policy principles have not been covered in their clinical study or research agreement), in line with good publications practice.
- We may, under a service agreement at fair market value rates, pay an author fees for non-author services associated with publication development such as statistical analysis. Any fee for service must be disclosed in the publication.
- We may reimburse reasonable travel and registration expenses for presenter attendance at scientific meetings.

GENERAL AUTHORSHIP REQUIREMENTS

- We ensure that authors of our publications meet all 4 ICMJE criteria for authorship:
 1. provide substantial contributions to the conception or design of the work or the acquisition, analysis, or interpretation of data for the work;
 2. draft the work or revise it critically for important intellectual content;

3. grant final approval of the version to be published; and
 4. agree to be accountable for all aspects of the work in ensuring that questions related to the accuracy or integrity of any parts of the work are appropriately investigated and resolved.
- We make a good-faith effort to include appropriate external clinical investigators as authors on publications involving clinical trial data to ensure that analysis and interpretation of our study data benefit from contributors having direct and recent experience with clinical practice and patient care.
 - Significant contributors who meet fewer than all 4 of the ICMJE criteria for authorship are acknowledged in the publication.
 - We do not offer authorship as an incentive or reward for services rendered such as patient enrolment or technical assistance with the study.
 - We apply the authorship requirements to both external investigators and company employees.
 - We avoid having excessive numbers of authors on our publications to ensure that each author can make a substantial intellectual contribution. Other contributors are acknowledged as non-author contributors or collaborators.
 - For employees leaving AstraZeneca, authorship on publications from the research they have contributed to will depend on them meeting all ICMJE authorship recommendations and any other conditions relating to confidentiality and conflict of interest.
 - Continued authorship rights and responsibilities of departing employees are agreed upon through discussions with their project leaders, line managers, publications experts and potential co-authors before they leave the company and are documented in writing.
 - In the event of changes to aspects of the design, concept, analysis, or, interpretation of a study or project, a former employee may still qualify for authorship if all ICMJE criteria are fulfilled.
 - We list former employees in the author list with their affiliation listed as AstraZeneca to indicate where the research was conducted. The current affiliation is listed as a footnote or in the acknowledgments unless journal guidelines state otherwise.

USE OF PROFESSIONAL WRITERS

- We may employ professional writers (company employees, external consultants or communication agencies) to assist in developing publications and presentations.
- We ensure that collaboration between professional writers and authors adheres to ethical practice, as follows:
 - authors must agree to the writer's involvement,
 - authors provide input and approve the general content and direction of the article before it is written and through all stages of development,
 - authors are responsible for data interpretation and for providing opinion on the significance of the data,
 - authors approve the final version of the article before it is submitted to a journal and retain full responsibility for the article's content, and
 - contribution of professional writers and their funding by AstraZeneca must be fully acknowledged in the publication in line with their levels of contribution.
- We share this publications standard with professional writers or external independent communications agencies working with us, and they will acknowledge in writing that this standard has been read and understood.
- Staff employed by public relations companies as professional writers will not be used in the development of AstraZeneca scientific publications.

PUBLICATIONS REVIEW AND SIGN-OFF PROCESS

- We review and sign-off on all publications sponsored by AstraZeneca prior to submission to a journal or congress using the Publications Sign-off (PSO) process.
- We conduct PSO without influencing the opinions of investigators or authors, acknowledging that authors are publicly accountable for work they publish and have the right to make decisions on content as long as scientific accuracy, intellectual property, and patient privacy concerns have been addressed.

- Company personnel in commercial roles will not participate in publication content development, review or sign-off processes, although they may be involved in publication strategy development as part of a multidisciplinary team process.

PRIOR AND DUPLICATE PUBLICATION

- Publication of a primary manuscript (first publication of primary endpoints) in a peer-reviewed journal is the most important communication of our study results. We ensure that the primary publication is not compromised by prior inappropriate communication activities, including case study and data subset reporting from individual sites.
- Abstracts, posters, oral presentations and posting of summaries of clinical trial results on public trial registries does not constitute prior publication and will not compromise publication in a peer-reviewed journal.
- Media coverage based on abstracts, posters and oral presentations does not constitute prior publication as long as the findings have not been disseminated in a promotional manner to the media, or amplified by supplementary data such as tables and illustrations.
- We generally do not submit duplicate publications to separate journals or congresses, although this sometimes may be acceptable in the same or another language, providing certain criteria are met and the original publication is cited. Such publications will reference all potentially duplicative submissions and previous communications of the same or similar work.
- Multiple publications arising from a single study will include the unique trial identifier, when available, and cite the primary publication.
- We do not engage in plagiarism even if it is from the author's previous work (self-plagiarism). Copyright permission and appropriate citation is required to re-use work.
- We abide by the rules of scientific congresses regarding submission and presentation of findings from a study that has been presented at another congress. Most disallow duplicate presentation but allow re-presentation of the study for which there has been a significant update to the original data set or analysis. Re-presentation at different congresses can be justified on the basis of different attendees (eg, different discipline or geographical variation).

AUTHOR DISCLOSURES

- We require all authors to disclose any potential conflicts of interest including any financial or personal relationships that might be perceived to bias their work.

PREDATORY PUBLISHERS

- We will not submit publications to known predatory journals or congresses who use an exploitive business model involving charging publication fees without providing the standard editorial, peer review, and publishing services.

DIGITAL PUBLICATIONS AND SUPPLEMENTAL MATERIALS

- It is acceptable for authors of our publications to develop supplemental digital content (eg. slide presentations or audio abstracts) to accompany a published manuscript or congress presentation when such content is a standard offering of the journal or congress.
- AstraZeneca-sponsored supplementary/enhanced content will be fully consistent with the abstract/manuscript, with no additional data or interpretation included that was not in the original publication.

RISK ASSESSMENT AND MONITORING

- Functional line management whose staff manage publications are accountable for ensuring that a first-line monitoring plan is in place to assess compliance with our publications Standard and procedures.
- We monitor risk on a regular basis – at least annually, depending on need & resource capability.
- We include all types of publications and monitor a sufficient number to ensure a robust

assessment of a functional area's compliance with policy.

- Generally, the number of publications monitored should represent at least 5% of the total number of publications completed within a year.
- Activities included in a monitoring plan should be based on specific risks that have been identified through a risk assessment process that is specific to the functional area.
- At a minimum, the activities monitored should include compliance with requirements for:
 - the PSO process,
 - disclosures of sponsorship, medical writing support and potential author conflicts of interest,
 - external author agreements,
 - ICMJE authorship recommendations, and
 - recording of publication transfers of value to US HCPs.